CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 07

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

If you were to look closely at the contents of an ordinary household dustbin, you would find that more than half of what is thrown away is wrapped, packed or carried in plastic. A biscuit packet, a carry bag, a straw, a toothbrush: each one is used for a few minutes and thrown away, yet will take hundreds of years to break down. It is a strange arrangement in which the useful life of a thing is a morning and its harmful life is a century.

Plastic is not the villain of the story. It is light, cheap and strong, and it has made medicines safer and food fresher. The harm arises from our habit of using it once and forgetting it. Rivers carry it to the sea; fish and birds mistake it for food; and in many cities, drains choked by plastic turn a heavy shower into a flood.

The first step is to reduce. A shopper who carries a cloth bag, a steel bottle and a small lunch box refuses perhaps a thousand pieces of plastic in a year. The second is to reuse: a jar becomes a container, a bucket becomes a plant pot. The third is to recycle, but this works only if waste is separated at home. A mixed heap of vegetable peels, paper and polythene cannot be sorted easily, and so most of it ends up in a landfill or in a drain.

Some cities have shown that change is possible. They have banned the thinnest bags, paid ragpickers fairly for collected plastic and turned recycled waste into tiles and benches. Such success stories remind us that the problem is not hopeless, only unfinished.

Some governments have tried banning carry bags, with mixed results. A ban works when there is a cheap alternative ready. In a town in Kerala, for example, women's groups began stitching cloth bags from old sarees and selling them at the vegetable market for a few rupees. The ban succeeded there because shoppers were given something better than a lecture.

What can an ordinary person do? Carry a cloth bag. Refuse a straw. Choose a steel bottle over a disposable one. Separate wet and dry waste so that recyclers can use what is useful. None of these acts will save the planet by itself. But a habit is a vote cast every day, and a million habits can change what the market decides to sell.

(i) More than half of the contents of a dustbin is: 1

(a) paper **(b)** metal

(c) wrapped or packed in plastic **(d)** food

(ii) The 'strange arrangement' mentioned means that plastic: 1

(a) is expensive but useful **(b)** is used for minutes but harms for centuries

(c) is hard to make **(d)** is cheap and weak

(iii) According to the writer, plastic is: 1

(a) totally harmful
(b) a natural material
(c) useless
(d) useful but harmful when used once and forgotten

(iv) The ban on carry bags worked in the Kerala town because: 1
(a) cloth bags were available as a cheap alternative
(b) shops were closed
(c) heavy fines were charged
(d) plastic was costly

(v) A habit is compared to: 1
(a) a rule
(b) a vote cast every day
(c) a gift
(d) a tax

(vi) How does plastic cause floods in cities? 1

(vii) Who stitched the cloth bags in the Kerala town? 1

(viii) Mention two things that an ordinary person can do to reduce plastic. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'to divide into parts or sort out'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'blocked'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The municipal council of a medium-sized town wished to know how much plastic waste was reaching its landfill. For one week, workers weighed the plastic collected in four localities, and a team of volunteer college students visited houses to explain how to separate dry waste. At the end of the week, the quantity of waste collected and the portion that was sent for recycling were entered in a table.

A town survey recorded the plastic waste collected from four localities in a week and the share that was recycled.

Locality	Waste collected (kg)	Recycled (kg)
Gandhi Nagar	400	100
Lake View	300	150
Market Road	500	100
Green Park	200	160

The council's health officer said that a locality's score depends mainly on how seriously its residents separate waste at home, and not on its size. He announced that the best-performing locality would get a free set of coloured bins, and that the council would hold a small award ceremony for it. Residents of the localities with low figures were invited to a meeting to understand how recycling works. Students of the local college offered to prepare short street plays on waste segregation, to be shown on Sunday mornings in the market.

(i) Which locality collected the most plastic waste? 1
(a) Green Park **(b)** Lake View **(c)** Market Road **(d)** Gandhi Nagar

(ii) Which locality recycled the highest share of its waste? 1
(a) Green Park **(b)** Lake View **(c)** Gandhi Nagar **(d)** Market Road

(iii) The total waste collected in the four localities was: 1
(a) 1,000 kg **(b)** 1,500 kg **(c)** 1,400 kg **(d)** 1,200 kg

(iv) How much waste was recycled in all? 1

(v) What percentage of Lake View's waste was recycled? 1

(vi) How much waste from Market Road was not recycled? 1

(vii) What percentage of Green Park's waste was recycled? 1

(viii) Suggest one step to improve recycling in Market Road. 1

(ix) Which locality probably has the best waste-sorting habit? Why? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'places in a town'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND